

Daniel Morris

PhD candidate in cognitive neuroscience

Northwestern University, Cresap 211

✉ danielmorris@u.northwestern.edu

🌐 pallerlab.psych.northwestern.edu/

🆔 0009-0005-4579-817X

📧 Daniel-Morris-19

in [daniel-morris97](#)

Education

- 2022–present **PhD in Psychology, Projected Date of Completion: 2028, Northwestern University**
Specialization in Cognitive Neuroscience
PI: Ken A. Paller
- 2016–2020 **B.A. in Neuroscience, Middlebury College**
Minor in Religion
Advisor: Jason Arndt

Publications

- 2026 **Morris D. J.**, Torres-Platas, S. G., Konkoly K. R., Hirschle, J., Sangpo, L., Thabkhe, Legden, T., Pelmo, L., Pasang, T., Grabowecky, M., Nusslock, R., Paller, K. A. Inducing lucid dreaming based on a contemplative practice of compassion. *Brain Sciences*, 16(3), 2026, <https://doi.org/10.3390/brainsci16030315>
- 2026 Konkoly K., **Morris D. J.**, Hurka, K., Sanders, K., Paller, K. A. Experimentally provoking dreams of unsolved puzzles during REM sleep boosts creative problem solving. *Neuroscience of Consciousness*, Issue 1, 2026, niaf067 <https://doi.org/10.1093/nc/niaf067>
- 2026 Konkoly K., Al-Youssef S., Mazurek C., Mallett R., **Morris D. J.**, Gales A., Arnulf I., Oudiette D., Paller K. A. Using real-time reporting to investigate visual experiences in dreams. *Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience* 2026; 38 (2): 365–380. <https://doi.org/10.1162/JOCN.a.107>
- 2025 **Morris D. J.**, Elliott, D. B., Torres-Platas, S. G., Wall, J., Demšar, E., Konkoly, K. R., Rosman, E., Grabowecky, M., Glowacki, D. R., Paller, K. A. (2025). Lucid dreaming of a prior virtual-reality experience with ego-transcendent qualities: A proof-of-concept study. *Neuroscience of Consciousness*, 2025(1), niaf017. <https://doi.org/10.1093/nc/niaf017>
- 2025 Konkoly, K. R., **Morris, D. J.**, Cho, M., Hurka, K., Torres-Platas, S. G., Baehr, L., Paller, K. A. (2025). Investigating dreams by strategically presenting sounds during REM sleep to reactivate waking experiences. *Neuropsychologia*, 217, 109229. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.neuropsychologia.2025.109229>
- 2025 Ellis, B., **Morris, D. J.**, Peterson, A., Marquetti, I., Manietta, L., Borg, M., Halliday, S., Malik, A., Sandbo, N., Gangnon, R., Francois, C. J., Teodorescu, M. (2025) Gastroesophageal Reflux, Sleep-Disordered Breathing, and Outcomes in Patients With Idiopathic Pulmonary Fibrosis. *Canadian Respiratory Journal*, 2025, 4228567. <https://doi.org/10.1155/carj/4228567>
- 2024 Mundt J., Pruiskma K., Konkoly K., Casiello-Robbins C., Nadorff M., Franklin R., Karanth S., Byskosh N., **Morris D.**, Torres-Platas G., Mallet R., Maski K., Paller K. A. Treating narcolepsy-related nightmares with cognitive behavioural therapy and targeted lucidity reactivation: A pilot study. *Journal of Sleep Research*, e14384. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jsr.14384>
- 2024 Wolk N., **Morris D.**, Nahas Y., Konkoly K., Carr M., Paller K. A., Mallet R. Lucid dreams from reactivating mindfulness during REM sleep: A pilot study. *International Journal of Dream Research*. 17(2), 224–227. <https://doi.org/10.11588/ijodr.2024.2.98233>

- 2023 Konkoly K., Picard-Deland, C., **Morris D.**, Mallet R. (2023) Dreaming outside the Box: Evidence for memory abstraction in REM Sleep. *The Journal of Neuroscience*. 43(42), 6952-6953. <https://doi.org/10.1523/JNEUROSCI.1374-23.2023>
- 2021 **Morris D.**, Baird B. (2021). Lucid dreaming. In J. R. Bertisch (Ed.), *Encyclopedia of Sleep and Circadian Rhythms (Second Edition)*. Elsevier. <https://doi.org/10.1016/B978-0-12-822963-7.00035-9>

Grants

- 2025-2027 **Varela Grant \$25,000**, *Mind and Life Foundation*
Integrating Tibetan Dream Yoga and Western Techniques for Lucid Dream Induction.
- 2023-2024 **DreamScience Foundation Grant \$4,000**, *International Association for Study of Dreams*
What factors determine whether sounds are incorporated into dreams? An overnight serial-awakenings study.
- 2018 **Summer Internship Funding Grant \$3,000**, *Middlebury College*
D Acres of NH Permaculture Farm and Educational Homestead

Teaching Experience

- | | | |
|--------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 2024/6 | Brain Damage and the Mind | <i>Assistant Instructor</i> |
| 2024/5 | Research Methods | <i>Assistant Instructor</i> |
| 2023/5 | Buddhist Psychology | <i>Assistant Instructor</i> |
| 2023/4 | ETSI Winter Research Training Program | <i>Assistant Instructor</i> |
| 2023 | Statistical Methods in Psychology | <i>Assistant Instructor</i> |

Presentations

- 2026 A dream-engineering database and treatment of trauma-related nightmares. Presentation at the T32 Training Day at Northwestern University
- 2026 A laboratory dream-engineering database. Presentation at the Neuroscience of Dreaming Conference in Lucca, Italy
- 2026 Targeted lucidity reactivation during sleep for treatment of trauma-related nightmares. Presentation at the Cognitive Neuroscience Brain Mapping group.
- 2025 Studying lucid dreaming in collaboration with Tibetan monastic scholars. Lecture presentation in Psychology 249 Buddhist Psychology at Northwestern University.
- 2024 Lucid dreaming. Presentation at the Sixth Conference on Ancient and Modern Wisdom, Drepung Gomang Monastery.
- 2024 What factors determine whether sounds incorporate into dreams? An overnight serial-awakening study. Symposium talk at the International Association for the Study of Dreams in Kerkrade, Netherlands.
- 2023 Lucid dreaming. Lecture presentation in Psychology 249 Buddhist Psychology at Northwestern University.

Selected Published Abstracts

- 2026 **Morris D.**, Konkoly, K., Torres-Platas, S. G., Hirschle, J., Kethamukkala, P., Ericson, E., Paller K. A., *A Laboratory Dream-Engineering Database* Poster presented at the 2026 Dream Engineering Conference in Boston, MA, USA.
- 2025 **Morris D.**, Konkoly, K., Paller K. A., *When does an external sound become part of a dream? An exploration of EEG predictors, real-time signals, sleep stage, and temporal factors* Poster presented at the Cognitive Neuroscience Society in Boston, MA, USA.

- 2024 **Morris D.**, Konkoly, K., Hurka K., Paller K. A., *Can we experimentally induce a dream of our choosing?* Poster presented at the International Association for the Study of Dreams in Kerkrade, Netherlands.
- 2024 **Morris D.**, Elliott B., Torres-Platas G., Rosman E., Davis R., Demšar E., Wall J., Glowacki D., Paller K. A., *Can Lucid Dreaming Enhance Compassion and Interconnectedness Following a Buddhist-Inspired VR Experience?* Poster presented at the Mind and Life Summer Research Institute in Garrison, NY, USA.
- 2024 **Morris D.**, Konkoly, K., Hurka K., Paller K. A., *Can we experimentally induce a dream of our choosing?* Poster presented at Cognitive Neuroscience Society in Vancouver, CA.
- 2023 **Morris D.**, Konkoly K., Paller K. A., *Sensory Disconnection and Lucid Dreams, a Multi-Study Analysis.* Poster presented at the International Association for the Study of Dreams in Ashland, OR, USA.
- 2023 **Morris D.**, Konkoly K., Satoru Suzuki, Paller K. A., *Lucid dreamers respond to auditory cues, especially following periods of high EEG theta power.* Poster presented at the Cognitive Neuroscience Society in San Francisco, CA, USA.
- 2022 **Morris D.**, Baird B. *Inducing Lucid Dreams with Optimized Sensory Cues.* Poster presented at the International Association for the Study of Dreaming Conference in Tucson, AZ, USA.
- 2021 **Morris D.**, *The Role of Pulmonary Dysfunction and Sleep Disordered Breathing in the Cardiovascular Dysfunction of Patients with Idiopathic Pulmonary Fibrosis.* Poster presented at the American Thoracic Society Conference in San Francisco, CA, USA.